

D705

Early Clinical in Special Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A candidate observing in a resource room with bright murals, under a mentor who has taught for 18 years, writes notes about one student during math. Which note is written objectively?

- A. "10:05-10:15: left seat 4 times; said 'This is dumb' once; completed 3 of 8 problems."
- B. "Seemed bored because the mentor's lesson was long."
- C. "Clearly has ADHD."
- D. "Was frustrated and lazy during math."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A candidate counts a student's call-outs: 12 during a 40-minute reading block on Monday and 9 during a 20-minute science block on Tuesday. Tuesday's class had a substitute aide. On which day was the rate of call-outs higher?

- A. Tuesday, 0.45 per minute vs. 0.30 per minute
- B. Monday, because 12 is more than 9
- C. They were the same
- D. Tuesday, because a substitute aide was present

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student's goal is no more than 0.2 call-outs per minute. In a 45-minute class, what is the most call-outs that still meets the goal?

- A. 20
- B. 225
- C. 2
- D. 9

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

ABC notes on a second grader show that when a writing task is handed out, he tears the paper, and he is then sent to sit in the hallway. He wears a favorite superhero backpack, and the class has 18 students. What is the most likely function of the behavior?

- A. Wanting to play with his backpack
- B. Escape from the writing task
- C. Getting peer attention
- D. Getting a tangible item

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A behavior is maintained by escape from hard tasks. Which response is most likely to make it worse?

- A. Teaching the student to ask for help.
- B. Any response, since function never matters.
- C. Sending the student out of the room whenever the behavior occurs.
- D. Breaking the task into smaller steps with a planned break after effort.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A candidate wants to use a vivid story about a student with autism from her placement in a course reflection, and to post a photo of the class's art project, which includes student names, to her personal social media. Her placement school is well regarded. What should she do?

- A. Use a pseudonym and remove identifying details in the reflection, and do not post the photo.
- B. Use the student's real name so the reflection is authentic.
- C. Post the photo, since it shows art, not faces.
- D. Ask other candidates if it is okay.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A fifth grader with a learning disability in reading has an IEP. On a science test taken in a quiet room with a new air purifier, he has the questions read aloud and gets 50% more time. The test covers the same content as his classmates' test. What are these supports?

- A. Environmental supports only, because of the air purifier
- B. Accommodations
- C. Related services
- D. Modifications

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which support for a student's math test is a modification rather than an accommodation?

- A. Getting extra time.
- B. Using a calculator on a test of problem solving.
- C. Taking the test in a small group.
- D. Solving two-digit problems while classmates solve four-digit problems.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

In an inclusive fourth-grade class, the general and special educators split the class into two mixed groups. Each teacher teaches the same fractions lesson to one group at the same time. The room has two whiteboards installed last summer. Which co-teaching model is this?

- A. Station teaching
- B. Parallel teaching
- C. Alternative teaching
- D. Team teaching, since both teachers teach

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

After leading a small-group phonics lesson in a room with a squeaky door, a candidate writes: "The lesson went well and the kids seemed to have fun. My mentor was nice." Her mentor has asked for deeper reflection. What should she add?

- A.** A note to fix the squeaky door.
- B.** How she felt before and after the lesson.
- C.** A longer description of the lesson steps.
- D.** Evidence of what students learned, why parts worked or did not, and a specific change she will try next time.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

During a 30-minute observation in a self-contained classroom that recently got new beanbag chairs, a candidate tallies the teacher's feedback: 8 specific praise statements and 16 corrections. What is the ratio, and does it meet the recommended target?

- A.** 2:1, below the 4:1 target
- B.** 8:30, based on minutes
- C.** 1:2, well below the 4:1 target
- D.** 1:2, meeting the target

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher gives 6 corrections in a lesson. How many specific praise statements are needed to meet a 4:1 ratio?

- A.** 10
- B.** 1.5
- C.** 24
- D.** 4

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A candidate observing in a resource room ~~with bright murals, under a mentor who has taught for 18 years,~~ writes notes about one student during math. Which note is written objectively?

Target word: pick the objective note **Decides:** Observable actions with times, no interpretation.

A	Correct	Records observable actions, words, and counts.
B	Camouflage	Pulls on the mentor detail with a guess about cause.
C	Absolute language	A diagnosis a candidate cannot make from observation.
D	Confusion set	Labels and inferences, not observations.

2. Answer A Concept 2

A candidate counts a student's call-outs: 12 during a 40-minute reading block on Monday and 9 during a 20-minute science block on Tuesday. ~~Tuesday's class had a substitute aide.~~ On which day was the rate of call-outs higher?

Target word: compare rates **Decides:** $12 \div 40 = 0.30/\text{min}$; $9 \div 20 = 0.45/\text{min}$.

A	Correct	Dividing count by minutes makes the sessions comparable.
B	Dropped element	Drops the different session lengths.
C	Wrong stem number	No calculation supports equal rates.
D	Camouflage	Right day, wrong reason; the aide does not decide the rate.

3. Answer D Concept 2 · transfer

A student's goal is no more than 0.2 call-outs per minute. In a 45-minute class, what is the most call-outs that still meets the goal?

Target word: solve for count **Decides:** $0.2 \times 45 = 9$.

A	Confusion set	Treats 0.2 as 20 per class.
B	Inverted operation	Divides 45 by 0.2 instead of multiplying.
C	Wrong stem number	Reads the rate as a count.
D	Correct	$0.2 \times 45 = 9$.

4. Answer B Concept 3

ABC notes on a second grader show that when a writing task is handed out, he tears the paper, and he is then sent to sit in the hallway. ~~He wears a favorite superhero backpack, and the class has 18 students.~~ What is the most likely function of the behavior?

Target word: function **Decides:** Writing task → tearing → removed from task.

A	Camouflage	The backpack is irrelevant detail.
B	Correct	The consequence removes him from the demand.
C	Confusion set	Nothing in the notes shows peers reacting.
D	Adjacent category	No item is gained.

5. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

A behavior is maintained by escape from hard tasks. Which response is most likely to make it worse?

Target word: reverse: what reinforces the function **Decides:** Removing the task gives escape.

A	Adjacent category	A replacement behavior that helps.
B	Absolute language	Function decides which responses help or hurt.
C	Correct	Removal delivers escape, reinforcing the behavior.
D	Inverted operation	This is a support that reduces escape behavior.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A candidate wants to use a vivid story about a student with autism from her placement in a course reflection, and to post a photo of the class's art project, which includes student names, to her personal social media. ~~Her placement school is well regarded.~~ What should she do?

Target word: confidentiality action **Decides:** De-identify coursework; no student-identifying posts.

A	Correct	Protects student privacy under FERPA and school policy.
B	Inverted operation	Authenticity does not require identification.
C	Dropped element	Drops that names identify students.
D	Adjacent category	Peers are not the authority; policy and the mentor are.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A fifth grader with a learning disability in reading has an IEP. On a science test taken in a quiet room ~~with a new air purifier~~, he has the questions read aloud and gets 50% more time. The test covers the same content as his classmates' test. What are these supports?

Target word: classify the supports **Decides:** Same content and standard; format and timing changed.

A	Camouflage	The purifier is not the support being asked about.
B	Correct	They change how he takes the test, not what is tested.
C	Adjacent category	Related services are things like speech or occupational therapy.
D	Confusion set	Modifications would change the content or expectations.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

Which support for a student's math test is a modification rather than an accommodation?

Target word: pick the modification **Decides:** Changing the content or standard.

A	Confusion set	A timing accommodation.
B	Adjacent category	When computation is not the skill tested, a calculator changes access, not the standard.
C	Inverted operation	A setting change: an accommodation.
D	Correct	The expectation itself changed.

9. Answer B Concept 6

In an inclusive fourth-grade class, the general and special educators split the class into two mixed groups. Each teacher teaches the same fractions lesson to one group at the same time. The room has two whiteboards installed last summer. Which co-teaching model is this?

Target word: name the model **Decides:** Two groups, same content, simultaneous.

A	Confusion set	Stations rotate students through different content.
B	Correct	Same content taught to two groups at once.
C	Adjacent category	Alternative pulls a small group for a specific purpose.
D	Absolute language	Team teaching is both teachers leading one whole group together.

10. Answer D Concept 7

After leading a small-group phonics lesson ~~in a room with a squeaky door~~, a candidate writes: "The lesson went well and the kids seemed to have fun. ~~My mentor was nice.~~" Her mentor has asked for deeper reflection. What should she add?

Target word: what deepens reflection **Decides:** Analysis with evidence and a specific next step.

A	Camouflage	An irrelevant room detail.
B	Adjacent category	Feelings matter but are not analysis of learning.
C	Dropped element	More description still lacks analysis and action.
D	Correct	Moves from description to analysis to action.

11. Answer C Concept 8

During a ~~30-minute~~ observation in a self-contained classroom ~~that recently got new beanbag chairs~~, a candidate tallies the teacher's feedback: 8 specific praise statements and 16 corrections. What is the ratio, and does it meet the recommended target?

Target word: ratio and judgment **Decides:** 8:16 = 1:2 vs. 4:1 target.

A	Inverted operation	Flips the ratio.
B	Wrong stem number	Uses the observation length instead of corrections.
C	Correct	8 praise to 16 corrections is one praise per two corrections.
D	Adjacent category	Correct ratio, wrong judgment.

12. Answer C Concept 8 • transfer

A teacher gives 6 corrections in a lesson. How many specific praise statements are needed to meet a 4:1 ratio?

Target word: solve for praise **Decides:** 6×4 .

A	Confusion set	Adds $4 + 6$.
B	Inverted operation	Divides 6 by 4.
C	Correct	$4 \times 6 = 24$.
D	Wrong stem number	Uses the ratio number as the count.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	4	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Objective observation notes	Record what is seen and heard (actions, words, times) and keep interpretation separate; “Left seat 4 times in 10 minutes” not “was hyper.”	Writing labels and guesses about feelings as if they were observations.	Wording in a candidate’s field notes.
2	Measuring behavior: frequency, rate, duration	Frequency counts occurrences; rate divides the count by the observation time so sessions of different length compare; duration measures how long a behavior lasts.	Comparing raw counts from sessions of different lengths.	Counts from observations of unequal length.
3	ABC data and the function of behavior	Antecedent-Behavior-Consequence records reveal what a behavior gets or avoids (attention, escape, tangible, sensory); the function guides the support.	Choosing a consequence without asking what the behavior achieves.	A pattern in what happens right before and after a behavior.
4	Confidentiality in clinical work	Student records and IEP details are protected (FERPA/IDEA); candidates de-identify notes and discuss students only with school staff who need to know.	Using real names in coursework or sharing details with friends or on social media.	Where a candidate’s notes, photos, or stories about students go.
5	Accommodations vs. modifications	Accommodations change how a student learns or shows learning (timing, setting, format, response) without changing the standard; modifications change what is learned or expected.	Calling fewer or easier items an accommodation.	Whether the content or expectation itself changed.
6	Co-teaching models	One teach-one observe, one teach-one assist, station, parallel, alternative, and team teaching differ in how the two teachers and the students are grouped.	Mixing up parallel (two groups, same content) with station (rotating content) or alternative (small group for a specific need).	How the class is split and who teaches what.
7	The reflective practice cycle	Useful reflection moves from describing what happened to analyzing why (with evidence) to planning a specific change and trying it.	Stopping at a summary of events or at feelings.	A candidate’s written reflection.
8	Behavior-specific praise ratio	Aim for at least four specific positive statements for every correction (4:1), naming the exact behavior praised.	Generic “good job” or mostly corrective feedback.	Counts of praise and corrections.

Course scope (public description): Early Clinical Experiences is a pivotal course designed to bridge the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical teaching skills. This course offers aspiring educators an immersive experience in real classroom settings under the mentorship of experienced teachers. Candidates engage in a range of activities, including observation, to develop a deeper understanding of classroom dynamics, student engagement, and effective instructional strategies. Emphasizing reflective practice, the course encourages

participants to analyze their experiences, integrate feedback, and adapt their teaching methods accordingly. This experiential learning approach equips future teachers with the confidence and competence necessary to foster a positive and impactful learning environment for their students.